
THE FREE PLAYBOOK

8 STEPS TO LOOK STUPIDLY GOOD ON SOCIAL MEDIA

The proven 8-step system to make your business look
stupidly good online, without ever hiring a videographer

BY PULSE SOCIAL MEDIA

WELCOME TO THE PLAYBOOK

Hi, I'm Will, founder of Pulse Social Media. You're here because posting good, consistent content is a struggle. I can help. I shoot every piece of content my clients post myself. So everything here is what I do every day, not theory off the internet. Over the next few steps, I'll hand you the exact strategies I use to get my clients real results.

Here's what you'll get out of this playbook:

- **Step 1:** Win customers who are ready to buy
 - **Step 2:** Get recognised in a single scroll
 - **Step 3:** Never wonder what to post again
 - **Step 4:** Stop the scroll in the first 3 seconds
 - **Step 5:** Shoot like a pro on just a phone
 - **Step 6:** Create weeks of content in one afternoon
 - **Step 7:** Grow every week without posting every day
 - **Step 8:** Turn views into paying customers
 - **Bonus:** Turn happy customers into your best salespeople
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STEP 1 · DREAM CUSTOMER

WIN CUSTOMERS WHO ARE READY TO BUY, WITHOUT WASTING POSTS ON THE WRONG PEOPLE

Before anything else, know who you're selling to. Content that's fast and exciting won't suit someone buying flowers for a funeral. Who you make content for matters.

So work out a few things about them:

- When is their day free? Post when they sip their morning coffee, or when they wind down at night.
- Which platforms do they use? Facebook? Instagram? YouTube?
- Do they want to be entertained, helped, or informed?
- How do they talk? Formal, or relaxed and laid-back?

Here's how to pin it down. Don't write for 'everyone'. Picture one real person. Give them a name, an age, a job, and the problem that keeps them up at night. The more specific you get, the easier every post becomes. You're not writing for a crowd. You're writing for Sarah, the busy café owner who checks Instagram on her break and wants more bums on seats.

And you don't have to guess. The answers are right in front of you:

- **Talk to your best customers.** Ask why they chose you, and what nearly stopped them.
- **Read your comments and DMs.** Their words are your caption words.
- **Check who follows you.** Most platforms show their age, location and active hours for free.
- **Watch your competitors.** Whoever comments on accounts you admire is your customer too.

Once you know who you're talking to, the rest gets easier. You'll know what to post, when, and how to say it. You're not shouting into the void. You're talking to one person who's ready to buy.

EXAMPLE

A café owner stopped posting generic 'we're open!' updates and started talking straight to busy locals who want a quick, quality coffee. Same café, far more foot traffic.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Write a short profile of your dream customer: name, age, job, and the one problem keeping them up at night.

GET RECOGNISED IN A SINGLE SCROLL, WITHOUT A BIG BRANDING BUDGET

Want people to recognise your content the second it hits their feed? You need a clear brand voice. Write the same way across everything you post. Then people know it's you at a glance. That builds trust, and trust turns followers into customers.

So what is a brand voice? It's your business's personality, in words. If your brand were a person, how would they talk? Warm and funny? Sharp and direct? Would they say 'let's smash this' or 'let us help you achieve your goals'? There's no right answer. There's only what fits you and your customer. Most businesses never pick one. So their content reads like five different people wrote it.

Here's a simple fix. Pick three or four words for how you want to come across, say 'friendly, confident, no-nonsense, a bit cheeky'. Write every caption as if those words sit on your shoulder. Also jot down what your brand would never say. Knowing what's off-limits keeps you in your lane.

Lock these in so your voice stays consistent:

- **Tone:** formal or casual? Playful or serious? Pick one.
- **Vocabulary:** the words you use again and again, and the ones you avoid.
- **Point of view:** 'I' or 'we'? Keep it the same everywhere.
- **The little things:** emojis or none, short lines or long, how you sign off.

Your voice isn't just words. It's the look too. Your colours, fonts and photo style all sing from one songbook. Match your writing and your visuals, and people know it's you before they read your name. That's the goal.

EXAMPLE

Gymshark's captions always sound the same: punchy, motivational, a little cheeky. You know it's them before you see the logo.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Write down 4 words that sum up your brand's personality, then rewrite your last caption so it sounds like them.

STEP 3 · WHAT TO POST

NEVER WONDER WHAT TO POST AGAIN

One of the biggest things that trips people up? They don't know what to post. The fix: rotate three content buckets. Educate, entertain, and sell.

- **Educate:** teach them something useful. Tips, how-tos, and answers to the questions you get asked all the time.
- **Entertain:** show some personality. Behind the scenes, a laugh, a story. This makes people like you.
- **Sell:** tell people what you offer and how to buy. Don't be shy. Nobody buys what they don't know exists.

Most businesses only ever sell, then wonder why nobody engages. Aim for 80% educate and entertain, 20% sell. Ask for the sale every time and you're a billboard. Give value first, and you earn the right to sell.

EXAMPLE

A plumber posts a quick 'how to stop a tap dripping' video (educate), a blooper from a flooded job (entertain), then 'book your winter pipe check' (sell). Same week, three angles.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Write down 3 post ideas: one that educates, one that entertains, one that sells. That's your next three posts sorted.

STEP 4 · HOOKS

STOP THE SCROLL IN THE FIRST 3 SECONDS

You can make the best video in the world. But if the first 3 seconds bore people, nobody sees the rest. You're not up against other businesses. You're up against the thumb. Your hook, the first line or shot, decides whether they stop or scroll. Get it right, and the rest gets a chance.

- **Lead with the payoff:** 'Here's how to get X without Y.' Skip the slow wind-up.
- **Call them out:** 'If you own a café, watch this.' People stop for things about them.
- **Spark curiosity:** 'Most people get this completely wrong...'
- **Open on your best shot.** Never start with a slow pan or 'Hey guys, welcome back.'
- **Put a bold text hook on screen** in the first second, so it lands even on mute.

Spend as much time on your first line as the whole rest of the caption. It matters that much.

Then write the caption. The hook earns the look. The caption earns the trust, and the click. Keep the writing simple:

- Write like you talk. Read it out loud. If it sounds stiff, rewrite it.
- One idea per post. Don't cram three messages into one caption.
- Use short lines and white space. Big blocks of text get skipped.
- End by telling them what to do next. (Step 8 covers this.)

EXAMPLE

'3 mistakes killing your coffee sales' stops a café owner dead. 'Welcome to our page!' gets scrolled past in half a second.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Take your last post and rewrite the opening line three different ways, each one a stronger hook. Use the best.

STEP 5 · PHONE CONTENT

SHOOT CONTENT LIKE A PRO, EVEN IF ALL YOU OWN IS A PHONE

Good content on your phone is easier than it looks. Modern phones do most of the work.

Whatever you shoot on (iPhone, Pixel, Samsung), always use the back camera. Shoot at 60 frames a second for a smoother look you can slow down later. Shoot 4K if you like, but it barely matters.

Don't zoom in. The more you zoom, the grainier it gets. Stick to 1x or 0.5x. Talking to camera? Grab a mic and a tripod. Shooting lots of showcase content? A cheap gimbal is worth it.

But the camera settings are the easy part. Three things separate pro content from amateur: light, sound, and a steady shot. Nail those and you're 90% there.

- **Light:** keep the light behind the camera, on you, never behind you. A window in the day is the best free studio there is. Filming yourself? Face the window.
- **Sound:** bad audio kills a video faster than bad video. Film somewhere quiet, get close, and grab a \$30 clip-on mic if you talk to camera.
- **Stability:** a shaky shot looks amateur. Prop your phone up, use a tripod, or tuck your elbows in.
- **Framing:** leave a little space above your head, sit off-centre, and clear the background.
- **Depth:** don't shoot flat against a wall. Leave space between you and the background. A bit of foreground, or a background that trails off, looks more cinematic. The same works for a product: angle it so the shelf trails off behind it.
- **Showcase shots:** filming your shop or a product? Move slow and smooth. Mix a wide shot with tight close-ups. Shoot from a few angles. Let the camera glide.
- **Shoot vertical:** for Reels, TikTok and Stories, film in portrait (9:16) so it fills the screen.

One last tip: shoot a few extra seconds at the start and end of each clip. It gives you room to trim. Get the basics right and your phone footage beats businesses that spend thousands on a videographer.

Shooting photos, not video? The same fundamentals apply. Light, framing and depth matter just as much. But a photo lives or dies on a single frame, so slow down and nail it:

- Take ten, keep one. Shoot a few versions and pick the best. Storage is cheap.
- Catch a real moment. A candid shot of you working beats a stiff, posed one.
- Use the rule of thirds. Put your subject slightly off-centre, not dead in the middle.
- Edit light. A small lift in brightness and contrast is plenty. Don't over-filter.

Let AI do the grunt work. Before you film, ask an AI tool for a few hook ideas and a shot list. After, use AI editors like CapCut or Descript for auto-captions and clean audio. You still bring the real content. AI just speeds up the rest.

And if being on camera isn't your thing? This is the content I shoot for my clients, day in, day out, so they never have to.

EXAMPLE

Film one clip facing a window, then one with the window behind you. The first looks bright and pro. The second looks like a hostage video.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Grab your phone, set the back camera to 60fps, face a window, and film a real 20-second clip. Talk to the camera about what you do, or walk through your shop showing off a product.

STEP 6 · YOUR TIME

CREATE WEEKS OF CONTENT IN A SINGLE AFTERNOON, EVEN IF YOU'RE FLAT OUT

You know what to post now. The next hurdle is finding the time to do it, and for most owners, that's the one that quietly kills their posting. You wear ten hats already, and 'make content' slides to the bottom of the list. The trick isn't more hours. It's using the ones you have better.

The big fix is batching. Don't film, edit and post every day. Set aside one block, even a couple of hours a week, and shoot a whole batch at once. You're dressed, the light's good, you're in the zone. Knock out five or six videos. One afternoon can give you weeks of content.

Do the same with the boring bits. Write a batch of captions in one sitting. Edit a few videos back to back. Then schedule it all to post on its own while you run your business. Do the work once. Let it pay you back for weeks.

And forget the idea that every post must be perfect. A quick, honest two-minute video beats the 'perfect' one you never post. Done beats perfect, every time.

EXAMPLE

One owner blocks a two-hour Sunday shoot, walks away with a fortnight of content, then forgets about posting all week while it goes out on autopilot.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Block one 2-hour 'content session' in your calendar this week and film 5 clips back to back.

GROW YOUR AUDIENCE EVERY WEEK, WITHOUT POSTING EVERY DAY

One thing separates accounts that grow from ones that don't: consistency. Not luck. Not one viral video. Just showing up, again and again. The platforms reward regular posting, and so do people. See your content week after week, and you feel familiar. Familiar builds trust.

Consistency does two things. It gives the algorithm more chances to find the right people. And it trains your audience to expect you. The businesses that win are the ones people remember. You don't get remembered posting once a month.

But posting is only half of it. The other half is engagement. Social media is a two-way street, not a billboard. Reply to comments. Join the conversation on other accounts in your space. The more you engage, the more the platform sees you as active, and the more real relationships you build.

You don't need to be everywhere. Pick a schedule you can keep. Three solid posts a week, every week, beats ten one week and nothing the next. Consistency compounds. Keep showing up, and the results stack up.

Never run out of ideas. One of the hardest parts of staying consistent is thinking of what to post, week after week. This is where AI shines. Feed it your niche and your dream customer, and ask for 30 ideas, a month of hooks, or a week's plan. You'll never face a blank page again.

EXAMPLE

An account that posts 3 times a week for 3 months beats one that posted daily for a fortnight, then vanished.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Pick the 3 days you'll post each week, add them to your calendar as recurring events, and schedule this week's 3 posts today.

TURN VIEWS INTO PAYING CUSTOMERS

Views feel great. But they don't pay the bills. This is the step most people skip. They chase likes and forget the point: getting people to buy. Every post should point somewhere.

- **Always add a call to action.** Tell people what to do next: 'DM us PRICE', 'link in bio', 'book a call'.
- **Make buying easy.** A clear link in your bio, a booking page, a simple way to enquire. Don't make them hunt.
- **Use your DMs.** A comment or message is a warm lead. Start a real conversation.
- **Get them off the platform.** Move people to an email list or booking page. You don't own your followers. You own your list.
- **Mention your offer often.** People need to hear it more than once before they act.

The money truth: attention is only worth something if you use it. A small audience that buys beats a huge one that doesn't.

This is the bit most businesses never nail alone. It's a big part of what I do for my clients: turning attention into booked work.

EXAMPLE

A salon posts a great haircut transformation, then adds 'DM us CHAIR to book this week.' Comments turn into bookings instead of just likes.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Add one clear call to action to your next post, and make sure the link or booking page it points to actually works.

BONUS · TRUST & SOCIAL PROOF

TURN HAPPY CUSTOMERS INTO YOUR BEST SALESPEOPLE

Great content gets you seen. Trust gets you paid. People buy from businesses they trust, and social media is where that trust is won or lost. The good news: you can build it on purpose.

- **Show your work.** Post before-and-afters, finished jobs, the process. Proof beats promises.
- **Collect proof on autopilot.** Ask happy customers for a quick review or a few words on camera. Screenshot the kind DMs.
- **Put real customers front and centre.** A testimonial with a name and face beats anything you say about yourself.
- **Show the human behind the business.** Introduce yourself. People trust people, not logos.
- **Reply to everything.** Every reply shows there's a real person here who cares.
- **Remove the risk.** Guarantees, no lock-in, a free first chat. Anything that makes 'yes' feel safe.

Build proof into your routine. Every finished job is a before/after. Every happy customer is a testimonial. Capture it as you go, and you'll never run short of trust-building content.

EXAMPLE

A tradie started posting a before-and-after photo of every job. Within months he was booked out. The photos did the selling for him.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Next time you finish a job or make a customer happy, capture it (a photo, a screenshot, or a quick quote) and save it to a 'proof' folder on your phone.

DO THESE 9 THINGS TODAY

Reading is easy. Doing grows your business. Knock these out today and you're ahead of 90% of businesses on social media.

- **Dream customer:** write a short profile of one ideal customer, name, age, job, and their biggest worry.
- **Brand voice:** write down 4 words that sum up your brand, then rewrite your last caption to match.
- **What to post:** write 3 post ideas, one that educates, one that entertains, one that sells.
- **Hooks & copy:** rewrite your last post's opening line three ways, then trim the caption down.
- **Phone content:** shoot one real 20-second clip (or a strong photo) on your back camera, facing a window.
- **Your time:** block a 2-hour 'content session' in your calendar this week.
- **Consistency:** pick your 3 posting days and set them as recurring calendar events.
- **Turn views into customers:** add a clear call to action to your next post and check the link works.
- **Trust:** start a 'proof' folder and drop in your first photo, screenshot or customer quote.

The only rule: don't do all nine perfectly. Just start. Done today beats perfect next month.

WHERE TO GO FROM HERE

There you have it. The eight steps I use to help my clients show up, look professional, and reach the right people. From your brand voice to turning views into customers, get these working together and you'll be miles ahead.

But here's the catch. Doing all eight, every week, forever, while you run everything else? That's the hard part. Most owners start strong and fade by week three. Not because they're lazy. Because they have a business to run.

So if you'd rather run your business while someone handles the content, the strategy, the shooting, the posting, all of it, that's what I do.

Book a free, no-pressure chat and we'll talk through where your social media's at and how to take it further.

→ pulsesocialmedia.com.au/contact